

Amazon Echo Pop

Opening the doors with a bang

The Amazon Echo Pop showed up at the Digit Test Centre a

couple of weeks ago. A few days into the testing, I had written a first impressions article about the device, detailing my initial thoughts about the cheapest current-gen smart speaker in Amazon's line-up of Echo devices.

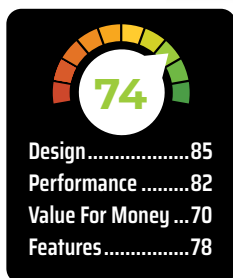
There were some doubts and questions I had when writing that article, which were all cleared up when I put the speaker through our rigorous test process. So, now having thoroughly tested the Echo Pop over the last couple of weeks, here's what I think about the device –

BUILD AND DESIGN

The build quality of the Echo Pop is solid, and it is aesthetically very pleasing, and it fits into my office desk setup with ease. If you are placing the device in an open environment, then the mesh of the device might collect some dust which can be easily cleaned off using a soft-bristled brush. When you are playing music, the feet at the bottom of the device hold it in place, and coupled with the weight of the Echo Pop, there's negligible rattle.

I placed it on a variety of surfaces, played bass-heavy music at max volume, and the device did not rattle or move from its place at all. There were a couple of instances where the device was moved from its position unknowingly by the folks here at the Test Centre, but the cable stayed connected, and the device did not incur any damage. Apart from that, there

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was no visible degradation of any materials used in making the Amazon Echo Pop, and it looks like it would last you a while. Just make sure not to use any abrasive cleaners on its surfaces.

FEATURES

As mentioned in the first impressions article, the feature set on the Echo Pop is limited. When I tested the device thoroughly, it was established that these features are well implemented as well. The inter-device connectivity of the speaker is also solid, and when turned off and turned on again, it doesn't take long to connect to the Wi-Fi network. I had mentioned in my first impressions article that the device at times had issues when communicating with other connected speakers, but over time, the issue seems to have resolved itself.

However, there were a couple of instances where it was surrounded by multiple boxes and gadgets on

my desk, and it took a bit longer to establish a connection with the Wi-Fi, but it did happen. I did not experience any unexpected drops in the connection as well.

The Echo Pop uses the Amazon Alexa app, which I spoke volumes about in my review of the Amazon Echo Dot (5th Gen, 2023). The same continues here. There are plenty of customisation options baked in which you can spend hours playing with and ensuring that the device is configured exactly to your taste.

My only gripe with the app continues here – the interface can be slightly overwhelming for first-timers. Quoting from my other review – “There are instructions every step of the way for the most part, but when they are missing, people can find themselves looking for that one specific setting for a fairly long time.”

This is more of a thing that Amazon needs to pay attention to because this is the entry-level Alexa-powered smart speaker that they sell. So, there will be plenty of people buying the speaker who are starting out with smart speakers for the first time. This means that the chances of users finding themselves lost are higher than it was with the Echo Dot.

With that aside, the overall feature set is exactly what one would expect from a device that is positioned like the Echo Pop.

PERFORMANCE

In terms of performance, the Amazon Echo Pop matches up to the expectations set by its pricier cousins. Be it vocal-heavy tracks or ones belonging to genres like Bollywood, hip-hop, and EDM, the speakers output a sound that you would expect from a speaker of this size. One thing I felt during listening to some bass-heavy tracks was that despite the heavy advertisement from Amazon about the bass-heavy nature of the sound, the speaker's sound signature lacked the bass.

This is out of the box experience that I am talking about. If you go